

Proposal for Emoji: Liver

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Identification

Suggested name: Liver

Suggested keywords: anatomy; biology; organ; food; cooking; laboratory test; transplant; donation

Suggested category: People & Body - body-parts

Suggested sort location: Near Anatomical Heart, Lungs, and Brain in the body-parts subgroup.

Required Example Images

Size	Color	Black and white
18x18		
72x72		

The proposed image shows a full, asymmetrical liver with a larger rounded side, a smaller tapered side, a visible diagonal dividing line, and an optional small gallbladder beneath the lower edge. Vendors may change the angle, shading, and color, or omit the gallbladder, while preserving the broad unequal outline at emoji size.

I, Shuhan He, certify that these example images are original work created for this proposal, that I own all IP Rights in them, and that they contain no third-party artwork, logo, trademark, or text. I release the images under the CC0 1.0 Universal Public Domain Dedication and grant the rights required by the Unicode Emoji Proposal Agreement and License.

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Factors for Inclusion

A. Multiple meanings

Not applicable. Anatomy, food, and healthcare are literal uses of the liver, not separate metaphorical meanings.

B. Use in sequences

Liver can combine with existing emoji to make three concise messages:

- Liver + Test Tube: “My liver-test results.”
- Liver + Pill + Warning: “This medicine may affect my liver.”
- Duck + Liver + Fork and Knife: “We’re having duck liver for dinner.”

The National Library of Medicine uses the term “liver function tests” and explains that these tests can check for side effects of medicines that affect the liver.

The Department of Agriculture lists duck liver among the giblets sold with whole birds, supporting the dinner message as a separate everyday use of the same organ image.

Sources:

- [National Library of Medicine: Liver Function Tests](#)
- [Department of Agriculture: Duck and Goose from Farm to Table](#)

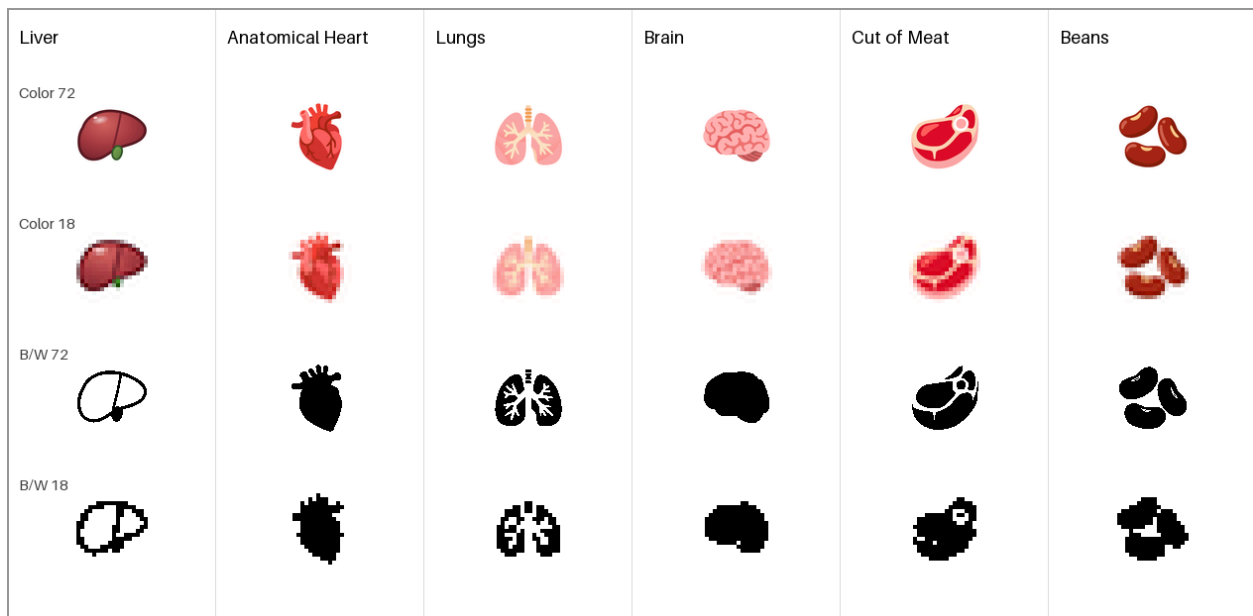
C. Breaks new ground

Yes. Existing emoji can express a test, medicine warning, meal, or generic meat, but none identifies the liver. Liver adds the missing noun in “my liver-test results,” “this medicine may affect my liver,” and “we’re having duck liver for dinner.”

Reference: [Current Unicode emoji list](#)

D. Distinctiveness

Even at 18x18, a liver has a clear profile: broad and low, with one large rounded side, one smaller tapered side, a notch underneath, and a diagonal line between the lobes. That shape is not upright like Anatomical Heart, paired like Lungs, round and folded like Brain, marbled like Cut of Meat, or divided into separate Beans. The green gallbladder can help in color, but the outline carries the identity in black and white too.



E. Expected usage level

Liver is a familiar word in anatomy lessons, cooking, and conversations about tests, medicine, donation, and transplantation. Public health pages describe liver anatomy, liver tests, medicine effects, donation, and transplantation. The Department of Agriculture also identifies duck liver as food. The five figures below measure the word `liver` itself. They show worldwide Web interest comparable to `elephant`, lower but sustained worldwide Image Search interest, and substantially higher recent English-language published-word frequency.

Sources:

- [National Library of Medicine: Liver Function Tests](#)
- [National Library of Medicine: Liver Anatomy](#)
- [Department of Agriculture: Duck and Goose from Farm to Table](#)
- [National Institutes of Health: Liver Transplant](#)

Google Search

Captured 2026-07-26. With Tools open, Google reports about 183,000 results for the unquoted term `liver`.

Open the reproducible Google Search query

The screenshot shows a Google search interface for the term "liver". The search bar at the top contains the word "liver" and has a "Tools" dropdown menu open. The menu options are "Any time", "All results", "Advanced Search", and "About 183,000 results (0.19s)".

Below the search bar, the "All" tab is selected. The main content area displays an "AI Overview" section. The text in this section states: "The liver is the largest internal organ in the human body, located in the upper right side of the abdomen. It performs over 500 vital jobs, including filtering blood, making bile to digest food, and storing energy." Below this text is a "Key Functions" section with a "Show more" button.

To the right of the AI Overview, there is a "Wikipedia" snippet titled "Liver - Wikipedia". It includes a small anatomical diagram of the human torso showing the liver's location and a brief description: "The liver is a major metabolic organ exclusively found in vertebrates, which..."

Below the AI Overview and Wikipedia snippet, there is a section titled "Cleveland Clinic" with a link to "Liver: Where It's Located, Function & Anatomy". The snippet text reads: "Sep 26, 2025 — Your liver is located on the right side of your upper abdomen. Its functions include filtering blood, making chemicals and fighting ..."

Below the Cleveland Clinic snippet, there is a "People also ask" section with four questions, each with a dropdown arrow:

- What are the first signs of a bad liver?
- What is the best drink to flush your liver?
- How do I fix liver problems?
- Where do you feel liver pain?

Below the "People also ask" section, there is a "Wikipedia" snippet titled "Liver". It includes a brief description: "The liver is a major metabolic organ exclusively found in vertebrates, which performs many essential biological functions such as detoxification of the organism"

At the bottom of the page, there is an "Images" section.

Google Video Search

Captured 2026-07-26. With Tools open, Google Video Search reports about 72,400,000 results.

[Open the reproducible Google Video Search query](#)

The screenshot shows the Google Video Search interface. The search bar contains the word "liver". The "Tools" menu is open, displaying various filters: "Any duration", "Any time", "Any quality", "All videos", "Any source", and "Advanced Search". At the bottom of the menu, it states "About 72,400,000 results (0.20s)".

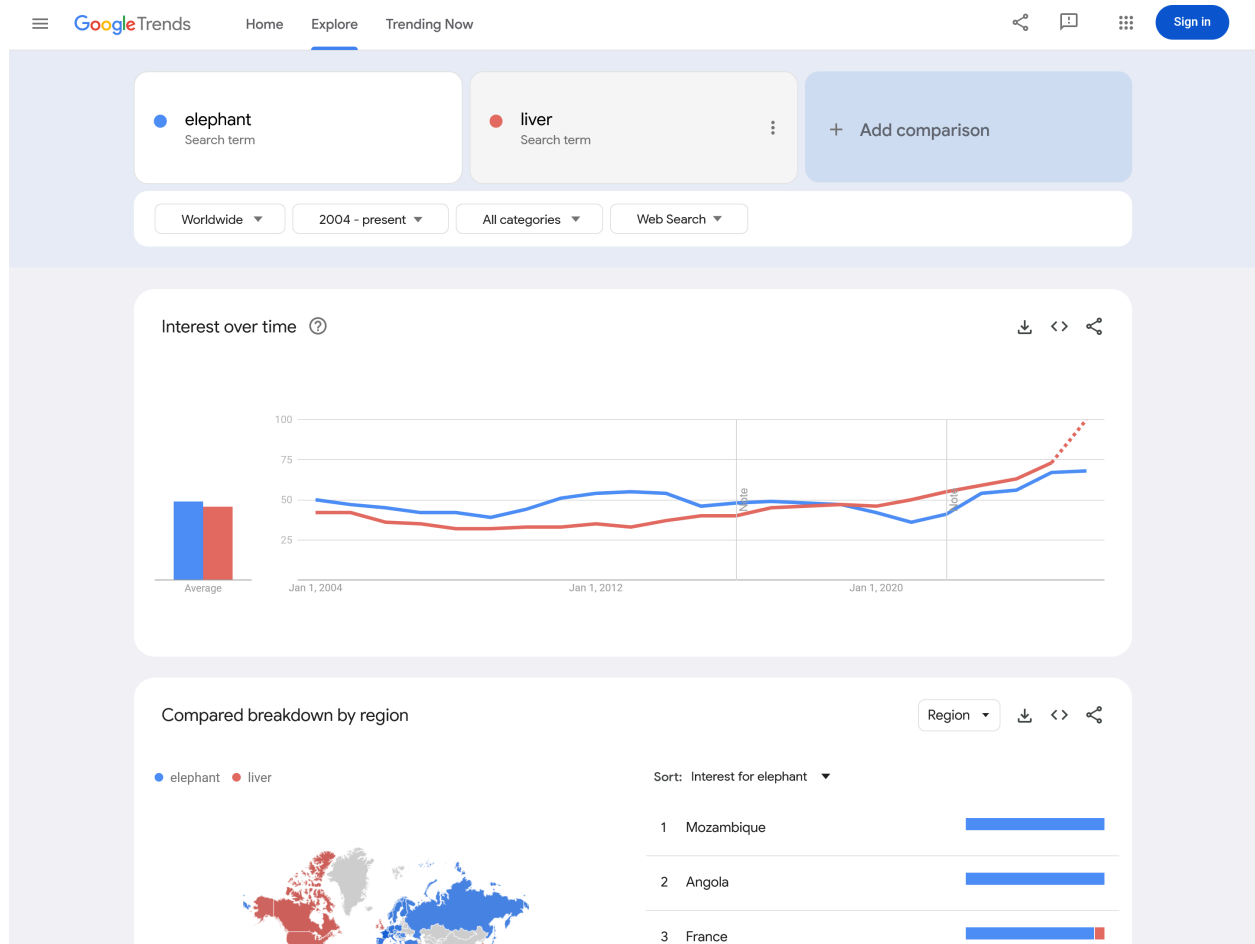
The search results list several videos:

- How The Liver Works**
For more information about how the liver works...
YouTube · Cleveland Clinic · Aug 12, 2024
4 key moments in this video
- Chronic Liver Disease - Yale Medicine Explains**
For more information on liver disease or #YaleMedicine, visit: https://www.yalemedicine.org/conditions/liver-transplant or ...
YouTube · Yale Medicine · May 2, 2026
3 key moments in this video
- Anatomy and Physiology of the Liver, Animation**
the proper hepatic artery carrying oxygenated blood from the aorta, and the hepatic portal vein carrying venous drainage from most of the ...
YouTube · Allia Medical Media · May 1, 2023
5 key moments in this video
- Liver Patient Education Videos: Video 2 The Liver English**
At Stanford Medicine Children's Health, our team of pediatric liver doctors (hepatologists) are leaders in treating complex pediatric liver ...
YouTube · Stanford Medicine Children's Health · May 30, 2024
- Understanding Cirrhosis & Liver Transplant: Risk Factors ...**
Understanding Cirrhosis & Liver Transplant: Risk Factors, Symptoms,

Google Trends - Web Search

Captured 2026-07-26 using Worldwide, 2004-present, and Web Search. Liver and elephant have comparable average interest across the full period, and liver exceeds elephant in the most recent portion of the graph.

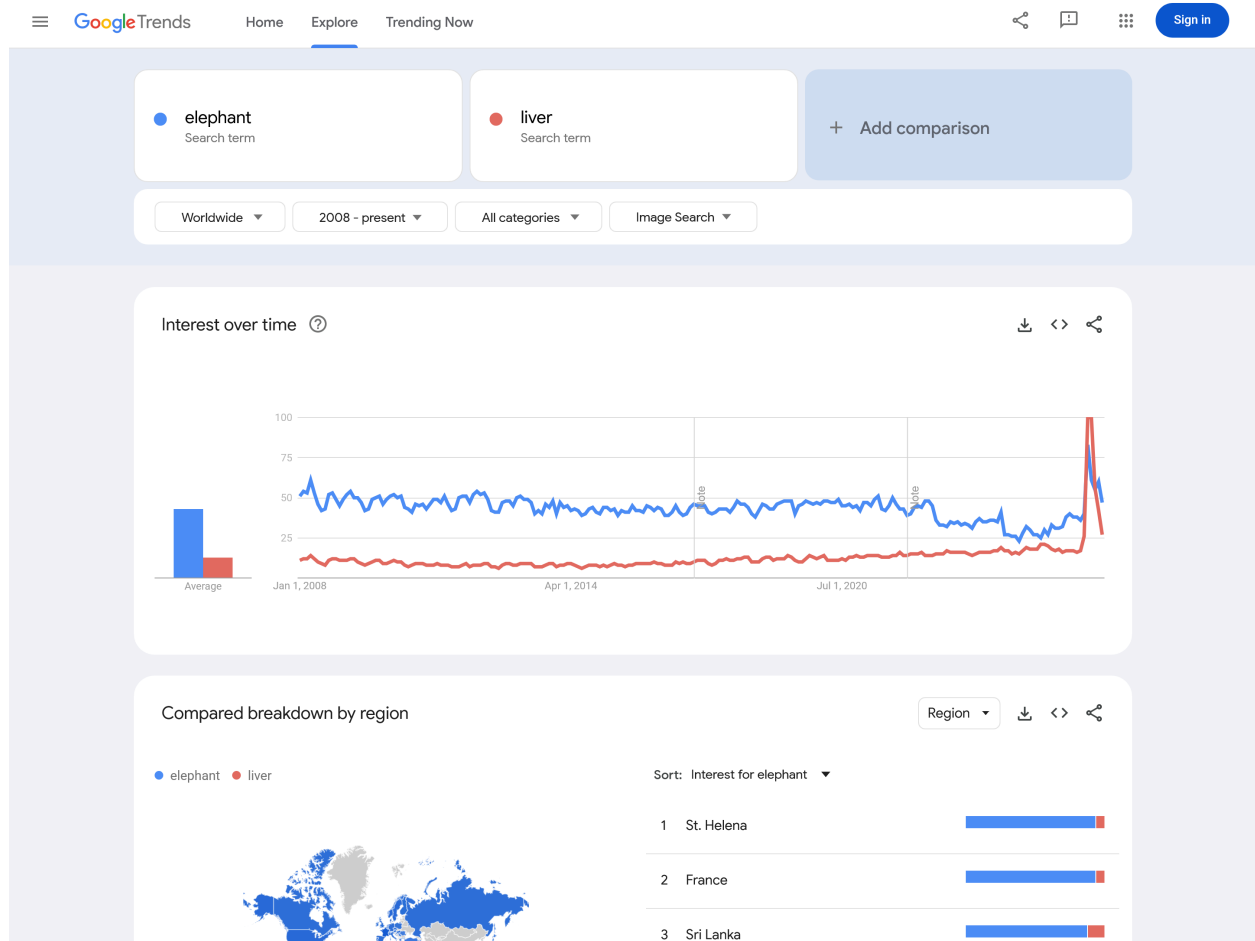
[Open the reproducible Worldwide Web Search comparison](#)



Google Trends - Image Search

Captured 2026-07-26 using Worldwide, 2008-present, and Image Search. Liver remains below elephant in average image-search interest while remaining present across the full period.

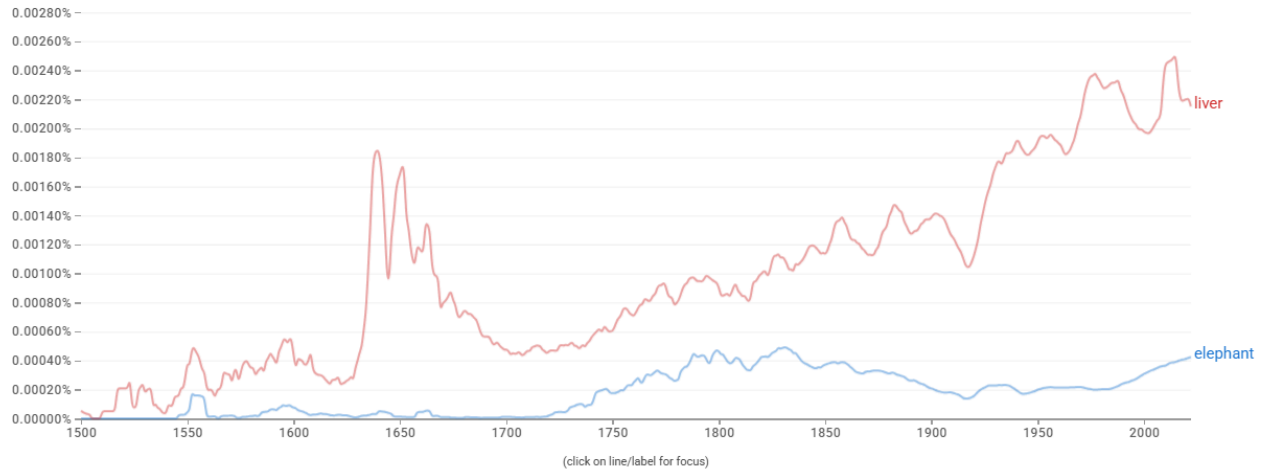
[Open the reproducible Worldwide Image Search comparison](#)



Google Books Ngram Viewer

Captured 2026-07-09 using the English corpus, 1500-2022, and smoothing 3. Liver substantially exceeds elephant in recent published-word frequency.

[Open the reproducible Google Books Ngram comparison](#)



F. Completeness

Not applicable. Anatomy is not a fixed set for this factor.

G. Compatibility

Not applicable. No qualifying popular-system pictograph is claimed.

Factors for Exclusion

A. Already represented

Test Tube, Pill + Warning, and Fork and Knife express the surrounding activity; Duck identifies the animal; Cut of Meat expresses a generic food category. None supplies the noun liver. Without it, the cited messages lose their anatomical or food subject.

B. Overly specific

The proposal is for the whole liver, not a lobe, disease, test result, transplant procedure, specialty, recipe, or campaign. It names a broad organ used in anatomy and biology, food and cooking, and healthcare.

C. Open-ended

Liver comes up in very different settings: learning anatomy, cooking a meal, reading test results, checking a medicine warning, or talking about donation and transplantation. In each case, the same image names the organ. This proposal is for that whole organ, not for a complete set of body parts, foods, tests, diseases, or procedures.

D. Transient

Liver is not tied to a campaign, event, or temporary technology. The English-language Ngram tracks the word through 1500-2022, and current government health and food pages still use it for anatomy, tests, food, and transplantation.

E. Faulty comparison

Anatomical Heart, Lungs, and Brain are shown only as visual and sorting references. Liver is proposed for the sourced messages and frequency evidence above, not because those emoji already exist.

Other Information

Essential design cues are a broad asymmetrical outline, a larger rounded side, a smaller tapered side, and a diagonal dividing line visible at 18x18. The gallbladder, shading, angle, and exact color are optional. Vendors should avoid a rectangular food cut or a featureless filled oval.

[Official Unicode proposal guidance](#)